

Scope-Creep Ask Cards — Round 2 (Scope Negotiation)

Day 5 · Round 2 handout. For the triad **playing the non-technical stakeholder**. You arrive with a scope-creep ask the author triad must handle without breaking their PRD. The author defends PRD §3 non-goals and §11 out-of-scope follow-ups — deciding whether to hold the line, cut existing scope, offer a phased plan, or escalate.

Public surface (both triads may read): the role and the headline ask. **Hidden (roleplayer only):** the real driver, your fallback, and how immovable you are. Don't reveal the Hidden section — make the author *discover* which trade-space axis you actually care about.

All asks are grounded in the FieldPulse "End-of-Day Reconcile" world.

Card 1 — PM Director

Public surface

- Owns the product line; RACI A on scope and launch date
- Headline ask: *"Marketing wants a **manager-view dashboard** in Reconcile before launch. Small ask, but they've committed to a campaign around it."*

Hidden — roleplayer only

- The real driver is the **campaign date**, not the dashboard itself. If the author offers a phased plan (dashboard in a fast-follow that still lands inside the campaign window), you can take it.
- Your immovable point is *the campaign* — you'll flex on *what* ships for it. If the author only argues "it's out of scope" without offering the campaign a win, keep pushing.
- Fallback you'll accept: a read-only stub for the campaign + full dashboard in v1.1, with a committed date.

Card 2 — Customer Success Lead

Public surface

- Owns renewals for the top-tier accounts
- Headline ask: *"Our **top-3 customer** just asked for **tablet support** in Reconcile. They've made it a **renewal condition**."*

Hidden — roleplayer only

- Tablet support is already a PRD §11 out-of-scope follow-up (deferred to v2). The account knows this is a stretch — the "renewal condition" is real but **negotiable**.
- What you actually need is something to bring back to the customer that isn't "no." A committed v2 date, or a written phased commitment, defuses it.
- Push the author on **time** (can v2 come sooner?) before you accept a hold-the-line "no." If they hold, they must give you the *reasoning and the date* to relay — a bare no fails.

Card 3 — Sales VP

Public surface

- Owns the enterprise pipeline; carries weight with the GM
- Headline ask: *"I have a **deal in flight** that needs Reconcile to support **multi-shop manager view**. Help me close it."*

Hidden — roleplayer only

- The deal is real but **not yet signed** — you're using urgency as leverage. Multi-shop view is a large scope expansion, not a small one.
- What moves you: a credible trade. If the author offers to cut a lower-value PRD item to fit a *thin* version of multi-shop view, or offers a phased commitment tied to the deal closing, you'll engage.
- You have authority the author might defer to — but a good TPM makes you **name the scope you'd trade away** rather than just adding on top. If they escalate to the GM cleanly with a trade-space framing, that's a win, not a loss.

Roleplayer reminders

- Lead with the **headline ask** only. Force the author to ask "why now / why this" to surface your real driver.
- The exercise tests whether they find the **trade space** — which of scope / time / quality / resources you actually care about — and offer movement on a *different* axis than the one you're pushing.
- Accept a good "yes-but," a phased plan, or a well-reasoned "no with a date." Reject a flat "it's out of scope" with no alternative.
- Every round ends with a specific outcome: agreement, phased commitment, deferral to a date, or a named escalation.

Author's decision menu (for reference)

When the ask lands, you have four honest moves:

1. **Hold the line** — and capture the *no with reasoning* (defend the §3 non-goal).
2. **Cut existing scope** to add the new ask (name what you'd drop).
3. **Offer a phased plan** — thin version now, full version on a committed date.
4. **Escalate** — because the stakeholder has authority you'd defer to (but escalate *with* a trade-space framing, not as a surrender).